

## Laundry Detergent Pods Pose Risk to Children

By: Chaz Wilke - Staff Writer



The easy-to-use laundry detergent "pods" designed to make the tedious chore of laundry a little easier can also pose a serious poisoning risk to your children, a new study finds. These pods' bright colors can make it easy for a youngster to mistake them for candy. And given the soft nature of the product, teething toddlers might assume the toxic cleaning product could be a soothing chew toy.

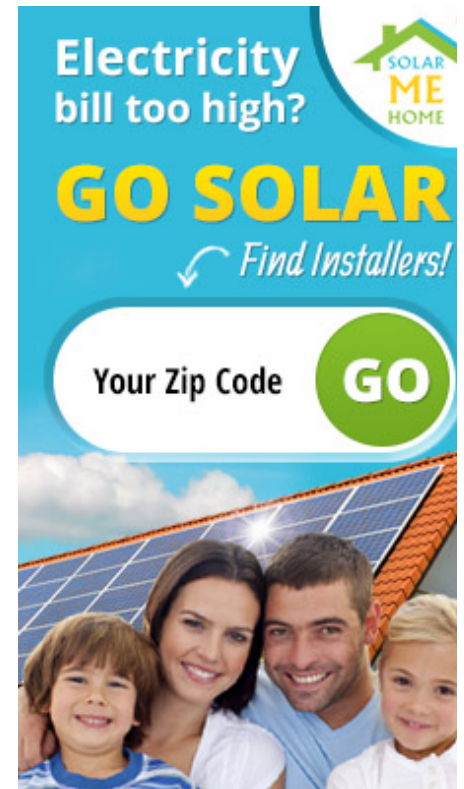
Mere seconds after entering the mouth, pods begin to deteriorate, releasing a toxic cleaning solution. Even if the child is under supervision, turning your back while emptying a load of laundry is all it could take for your child to stuff a pod in his mouth.

Arriving on the market in 2012, these laundry pods (pictured above) are a new and simple method of adding laundry detergent to your washing machine. Unfortunately, this product is so new that the elderly may also be confused by them. Jessica Morin, of Houston, Texas, found that out the hard way.

Morin's grandmother held Jessica's teething youngster, Marlow, while searching for a toy in the baby's diaper bag. She pulled out what she thought was a teething toy and handed it to baby Marlow.

Jessica quickly noticed something was wrong.

"She only had it in her mouth for a few seconds. She started to cough," Jessica told CBS News (<http://cbsn.ws/1yUcity>). "In the car, on the way [to the hospital], she was vomiting all over herself over and over again."



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Marlow's exposure to the toxic cleaning solution was minimal but the toddler still required medical attention. She was released that same day after receiving intravenous fluids.



## Recent Pediatric Study

On Sept. 5, 2014, the American Academy of Pediatrics released the [study](http://bit.ly/1xSpocv) (<http://bit.ly/1xSpocv>), "Pediatric Exposure to Laundry Detergent Pods," which contains surprising statistics on the dangers of children confusing pods with colorful treats.

"There were 17,230 children younger than 6 years exposed to laundry detergent pods in 2012–2013," the study says. "Children younger than 3 years accounted for 73.5% of cases."

The study concludes that detergent pods pose a serious risk to children, and that manufacturers should make improvements to labeling and packaging. The study also requests the allocation of additional resources to public education so instances like Jessica Morin's can be avoided in the future.



## Takeaway

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These new laundry detergent pods may be convenient, but they pose a risk to children who get ahold of them. If you have youngsters and you use detergent pods, consider switching to standard liquid laundry detergent. Keeping a close watch on your child may not be enough to avoid the confusion this candy-looking product can create.

"My daughter only had it in [her mouth] for a few seconds and she was impacted by it, so I can only imagine a toddler going to town on one and swallowing the entire thing," Morin said.

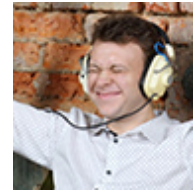
If you use pods, store them as you would bleach and other toxic household cleaning products.

*Chaz Wilke is an employee of Deka Marketing Group. Deka Marketing Group receives payment from advertisers on HomeLiving101.*



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